

Final Reflective Piece: Object Oriented Programming

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Introduction

This reflection critically examines my learning and professional development across the *Software Engineering Project Management (SEPM)* module, with focused attention on two core assessment components: the collaborative Unit 6 Group Project Report (GPR) and the Unit 11 Individual Video Presentation to stakeholders. Using Rolfe et al.'s (2001) reflective framework—*What?*, *So What?*, and *Now What?*—as the primary analytical lens, the reflection evaluates both collective and individual dimensions of practice within an agile, distributed project environment. Importantly, it focuses on how virtual team dynamics and independent professional delivery contributed to my knowledge and development as a software engineering practitioner.

What?

Although due in week 6, the Unit 6 group project required immediate engagement, providing a framework that guided all subsequent activities and meetings. The project team and contract was formed in Unit 1 and comprised five members across different time zones, immediately introducing coordination and communication challenges typical of virtual teams (Somanathan, 2023). Despite this, the group showed early procedural commitment by scheduling an initial synchronous meeting in which communication platforms were agreed and roles allocated (Mohammed et al., 2025). I assumed the role of Business Analyst, responsible for eliciting and analysing stakeholder requirements, identifying assumptions and ambiguities, and producing Behaviour-Driven Development (BDD) artefacts, including structured Gherkin statements (Kwiatkowski & Jarzebowicz, 2025).

The team adopted an agile working model, holding weekly meetings to plan tasks, track progress, and respond to emerging requirements (Strode et al., 2022). While this structure helped maintain momentum, its success relied heavily on individual commitment. Meeting minutes helped maintain continuity and shared understanding despite asynchronous participation, and I took

responsibility for recording three of the five meetings, serving as an informal mechanism for both personal and team accountability (Klunder et al., 2020). During Unit 6, my main contributions involved identifying explicit and implicit requirements from the stakeholder transcript, critically examining gaps and assumptions, and translating these into formal BDD specifications (Kwiatkowski & Jarzebowicz, 2025). This clarified the project scope for the team and showed how proactive, structured analysis can strengthen collaboration and shared understanding (Somanathan, 2023).

A significant challenge arose when the team member assigned as Project Manager did not consistently fulfil core responsibilities, such as scheduling meetings, monitoring progress, and maintaining task visibility (Kerzner, 2023). Consequently, coordination became a shared responsibility among the more active team members, myself included, to ensure continuity alongside our own roles. While this created gaps in coordination, it also offered me the opportunity to develop confidence and leadership skills—experience that proved valuable for the Unit 11 stakeholder presentation.

So What?

The initial establishment of roles and structured weekly meetings reflected recommended practices for virtual agile teams, where clarity and process help mitigate temporal and geographical constraints (Kerzner, 2023). However, the gap between formally assigned roles and actual engagement revealed a key limitation: procedural structures alone do not guarantee effective collaboration. Role blurring emerged as coordination and progress-tracking responsibilities were inconsistently fulfilled. While stepping into these gaps maintained continuity, it also demonstrated how uneven participation can shift workload onto a subset of team members, creating dependency rather than shared ownership (Strode et al., 2022). Emotionally, this generated both engagement and cognitive strain, reinforcing the tension between short-term delivery and long-term team sustainability.

Another critical factor was the team's collective reluctance to address underperformance directly. Interpersonal rapport remained positive throughout; members were respectful and supportive, and overt conflict was avoided. However, this avoidance limited accountability. Alami et al. (2024) argue that psychologically safe teams are those in which individuals can engage in constructive challenge without fear of interpersonal damage. In this case, harmony was prioritised over candid dialogue, resulting in unspoken frustration and reliance on a subset of members to sustain progress (Alami et al., 2024). This represents a key point of self-critique, highlighting how conflict avoidance can undermine effective collaboration even in well-intentioned teams.

While Unit 6 developed analytical and technical skills in requirements engineering and Behaviour-Driven Development, Unit 11 had the most profound impact on me. Preparing and delivering a 20-minute stakeholder-focused video required deep comprehension of project materials, revised plans, and cost analysis, alongside the ability to communicate clearly and persuasively. Unlike group discussions, this task demanded active engagement, professional authority, and rapid synthesis of technical and managerial knowledge under scrutiny, making it both cognitively and emotionally intensive (Bany Mohammed et al., 2025).

Overall, Unit 11's presentation crystallised the integration of technical and socio-professional skills, demanding not only analytical and presentation acumen but also leadership and reflective judgement under realistic stakeholder scrutiny (Kerzner, 2023). This experience reinforced lessons from Unit 6 while providing practical exposure directly transferable to professional software engineering practice (Strode et al., 2022).

Now What?

These experiences have deepened my understanding of agile as a socio-technical process, where methodology alone is insufficient without disciplined communication, accountability, and engagement (Bany Mohammed et al., 2024). Stepping into additional responsibilities highlighted

both the benefits and limits of informal role compensation, showing that proactive management of role balance and structured retrospectives can sustain equity and team resilience (Edmondson & Lei, 2022).

The intensity of the Unit 11 stakeholder presentation strengthened professional confidence, demanding clear and persuasive communication of technical, financial, and operational knowledge under scrutiny (Kerzner, 2023). This experience demonstrated that effective software engineering project management demands not only methodological expertise but also the ability to justify decisions, communicate strategically, and engage stakeholders—skills directly transferable to future roles in software development and project management. Reflective practice has helped highlight my current strengths and weaknesses in the field of SEPM, ensuring that my technical skills grow alongside my leadership, decision-making, and ability to collaborate effectively.

Conclusion

Using Rolfe et al.'s (2001) framework has helped me critically reflect on the module's technical and professional demands. Challenges in Unit 6 highlighted the need for accountability and collaboration, while the intense Unit 11 stakeholder presentation strengthened my confidence, leadership, and communication under scrutiny. Together, these experiences have strengthened my analytical skills, professional judgment, and reflective practice, providing a solid foundation for my future career in software engineering project management.

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